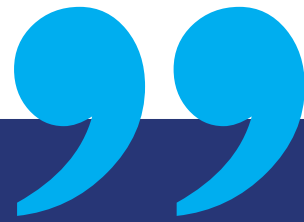




جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY



Program Description

Department of Fiqh and Its Fundamentals

Deanship of Graduate Studies

College of Business - Imam Bukhary University

Comprehensive Track

Master's Degree in Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals

College of Sharia - Imam Bukhari University



Statement	Details
Program Name	Master of Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals
Program Code	(0143)
Program Pathway	Comprehensive Track
Qualification Level	Level Nine
Scientific Department	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals
Faculty	Shariah
Institution	Imam Bukhary University
Program Description	() New (v) Developed
Date of Last Review	April / 2026



جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY

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Department of Fiqh and its Principles

Deanship of Graduate Studies

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About the Department:

To establish the department as a leading academic and research center in postgraduate studies in Fiqh and its principles, and as a beacon of knowledge contributing to enriching the Islamic library with original and peer-reviewed research, while graduating distinguished jurists and researchers capable of contributing to addressing contemporary issues in accordance with the objectives of Islamic Sharia.

The Mission:

Preparing researchers specialized in Fiqh and its principles, possessing a solid scientific methodology and the ability for disciplined deduction and ijtiḥad, through advanced postgraduate programs focused on the foundational study of Fiqh and Usul, and applying them to address contemporary issues and new cases, thereby contributing to serving the community and enhancing the religious reference.

Objectives:

The Graduate Program in Jurisprudence and its Fundamentals aims to achieve a comprehensive set of objectives, most notably:

1. Establishing the student's knowledge in jurisprudence and its principles by deepening their study of the sources of Islamic legislation, rules of deduction, and the schools of jurists, enabling them to understand the legal rulings and comprehend the differences among scholars and their evidences.
2. Developing specialized research skills through the preparation of rigorous scientific research that combines methodological grounding and critical analysis, addressing contemporary jurisprudential issues and current matters in light of the objectives of Sharia.
3. Preparing qualified scientific competencies capable of contributing to university teaching, issuing religious verdicts (fatwas), scientific research, and serving Sharia, judicial, and daʿwah institutions.
4. Enhancing the ability for disciplined ijtiḥad, and developing skills in weighing between jurisprudential opinions according to the principles of Usul al-Fiqh, while taking into account the reality and its variables.
5. Utilization of modern technologies in the service of Fiqh and its principles, through the use of jurisprudential databases, research software, and digital knowledge platforms in research and verification.
6. Linking jurisprudence to contemporary reality through the study of economic, medical, social, and legal issues, and providing Sharia-compliant solutions that consider the objectives of the Sharia and the requirements of the modern era.
7. Enhancing scientific and academic cooperation with specialized universities and research centers through the exchange of expertise and participation in scientific conferences and seminars, thereby contributing to the development of the program and the improvement of its outcomes.

Program Significance

The inauguration of the postgraduate program (Master's) in Fiqh and its Principles at Imam Bukhary University in the Republic of The Gambia represents a strategic step reflecting the university's orientation towards developing its academic system, enhancing its presence in the field of specialized Sharia studies, and responding to the requirements of higher education and the labor market needs in the fields of Fiqh and Islamic legislation.

The program is expected to attract a significant number of students wishing to specialize in Fiqh and its principles, and to acquire advanced scientific and methodological skills. This will contribute to elevating the academic standing of Imam Bukhary University, enhancing its scientific reputation at both regional and international levels, and supporting its institutional sustainability through high-quality scholarly outputs.

The importance of the program stems from the increasing need in Islamic societies—particularly in West Africa—for specialized scholarly cadres in Fiqh and its principles, who possess disciplined tools of *ijtihad*, comprehend the objectives of Sharia, and are capable of addressing contemporary issues and new cases in economic, medical, social, and legal fields. This contributes to achieving benefits and preventing harms, consolidating the approach of moderation and balance, and enhancing societal stability.

The program is also considered a natural extension of a comprehensive academic pathway provided by Imam Bukhary University, as it offers graduates of bachelor's programs in Sharia studies—particularly in Fiqh and its principles—the opportunity to pursue their postgraduate studies within the university. This enhances academic stability, elevates the level of scholarly qualification, and affirms the university's commitment to delivering progressive, quality education that aligns with accredited academic standards and sustainably meets the needs of society.

Additionally, the Master's program in Fiqh and its Principles contributes to meeting the needs of several vital sectors, as the employment opportunities available to its graduates are diverse. These include educational institutions and universities, Sharia and judicial bodies, fatwa departments, research centers, and *da'wah* and media institutions, alongside fields such as Sharia judiciary, arbitration, jurisprudential consultations, and work within civil society organizations concerned with Sharia awareness and the promotion of social harmony.

The program also opens avenues for employment in the field of teaching at schools and Islamic institutes, thereby contributing to the support of scientific and cultural development in Gambia, as well as in the African, Arab, and Islamic regions in general.

Employment Sectors Qualified for Graduates of the Master's Program in Fiqh and Its



Fundamentals.

Graduates of the Master's program in Fiqh and its Principles at the College of Sharia, Imam Bukhary University, are qualified to occupy specialized and distinctive positions that require advanced academic qualifications, analytical and deductive abilities, and advanced research skills. This qualification opens wide horizons for them in several sectors, most notably:

- 1- Educational and Academic Institutions (Universities and Colleges):** Working as a lecturer or academic researcher in the departments of Fiqh and its Principles or Sharia, contributing to the teaching of Fiqh and Usul courses, supervising research, and curriculum development.
- 2- Specialized Research Centers and Scientific Publishing Houses:** Working as a specialized researcher in jurisprudential and fundamental studies, a verifier of jurisprudential heritage, a scientific reviewer of Shariah publications, and participating in research projects related to contemporary legal issues and matters of Islamic jurisprudence.
- 3- Official Religious Institutions (Ministries of Religious Affairs, Fatwa Departments, Jurisprudential Councils, Councils of Senior Scholars):** Working as a Sharia advisor, fatwa researcher, or consultant on contemporary jurisprudential issues. Contributing to the issuance of Sharia fatwas based on evidence, and serving as a member of Sharia committees specialized in issuing fatwas and studying new legal cases.
- 4- Judicial Authorities and Sharia Bodies:** Working in Sharia courts, Sharia arbitration bodies, and the field of legal consultations of a jurisprudential nature (personal status, transactions).
- 5- Charitable, Relief, and Da'wah Institutions:** Working as a Shariah expert in charitable and relief projects, or as a Da'i and religious guide specializing in jurisprudential issues. Contributing to the foundation of charitable and relief work from a Shariah perspective, and providing training courses and awareness programs.
- 6- Islamic Banks and Financial Institutions:** Serving as a Shariah advisor and participating in the issuance of jurisprudential rulings related to Islamic financial transactions.
- 7- Religious Media Institutions and Knowledge Production:** Working as a producer of specialized religious programs in Fiqh and its principles, as a writer and researcher in contemporary Fiqh issues, and as a Sharia analyst for media content.
- 8. General Education and Sharia Institutes:** Working as a teacher of Sharia subjects, an academic or educational supervisor in educational institutions, and preparing and developing Sharia curricula.

The diversity of these entities reflects the significance of the Jurisprudence and its Fundamentals specialization across various fields of life, as well as the graduates' ability to contribute to achieving a balance between Sharia grounding and the demands of contemporary reality.

Study Plan for the Master's Degree in Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals: (Thesis Track)

The curriculum for the Master's program in Fiqh and its Principles, thesis track, consists of one academic year of coursework, followed by the preparation of a university thesis specializing in Fiqh and its Principles.

The detailed study plan is as follows:

The courses in this curriculum comprise a total of 44 credit hours, distributed as follows:

A. Components of the Study Plan:

Components of the Study Plan	Compulsory/ Elective	Number of Courses	Credit Hours	Percentage
Course Modules	Compulsory	12	40	81.5%
	Elective	4		
Complementary Research or Case Study	Compulsory	-	9	18.5%
Total		16	49	100%

B- Program Courses:

Semester or Level	Course Code	Course Title	Compulsory / Elective	Prerequisites	Prerequisites Credit Hours
First	MISJ1416	Jurisprudence of Transactions	Compulsory		3
	MISJ1415	Jurisprudential Rules 1	Compulsory		3
	MPOJ1414	Usul al-Fiqh 1	Compulsory		3
	MFJU1412	Family Jurisprudence	Compulsory		3
Second	MCRJ1423	Jurisprudence of Criminal Acts	Compulsory	MISJ1416	3
	MLOB1426	Objectives of Islamic Law	Compulsory		3
	MISJ1425	Jurisprudential Rules 2	Elective	MISJ1415	2
	MPOJ1424	Usul al-Fiqh 2	Compulsory	MPOJ1414	3
	MCLI1427	Contemporary Jurisprudential Issues	Elective		2



Third	MFUR1431	Fundamental Principles in the Differences of Jurists			3
	MPOJ1434	Usul al-Fiqh 3	Compulsory	MPOJ14124	3
	MCOF1435	The Classes of the Usulists	Compulsory		3
	MCOJ1436	Comparative Jurisprudence	Elective		2
	MSSS1437	Studies in the Sciences of the Sunnah	Elective		2
Fourth	MPOJ1444	Usul al-Fiqh 4	Compulsory	MPOJ1434	3
	MJTD1445	Jurisprudential Theories and Differences	Compulsory		3

Important Note: When elective courses are available at any academic level, the student must choose one of the two offered courses to fulfill the graduation requirements.

C- A supplementary research or case study totaling (9) credit hours, with its course code assigned by the Deanship of Graduate Studies. The length of the study in this track shall range between (50) and (75) pages, in accordance with the approved academic regulations and standards.

Learning Outcomes for the Master's Program in Fiqh and Its Principles

A graduate of the Master's program in Jurisprudence and its Principles at the College of Sharia, Imam Bukhary University, is expected to be capable of achieving the following outcomes:

a. Knowledge and Understanding:

a₁ - In-depth mastery of the concepts of Islamic Jurisprudence, its principles, and objectives, with an extensive study of its schools, general rules, and applications.

a₂ - Analysis of the methodologies of deduction from the legal evidences (Qur'an, Sunnah, consensus, analogy, and others) according to the advanced principles of Usul al-Fiqh.

a₃ - Comprehension of the jurisprudential schools, their evidences, and methodologies in preference, along with an understanding of the reasons for jurisprudential differences and their regulations.

a₄ - Understanding contemporary jurisprudential issues and emerging new cases, and linking them to the objectives of Sharia and the implications of rulings.

b. Cognitive (Intellectual) Skills:

- b₁ - Conducting an in-depth critical analysis of contemporary jurisprudential issues and new cases, according to a rigorous scientific methodology.
- b₂ - Comparing different jurisprudential opinions and preferring among them based on evidences, fundamental principles, and the objectives of Sharia.
- b₃ - Evaluation of Jurisprudential and Usul Studies, and their Critique According to an Objective Scientific Method.
- b₄ - Addressing doubts related to Islamic jurisprudence and responding to them in a well-founded scientific manner.

C. Professional and Practical Skills:

- C₁ - Preparation of original scientific research in Fiqh and its principles, according to advanced scientific research methodology, achieving a significant knowledge contribution.
- C₂ - Providing disciplined jurisprudential ijtihads and Shariah consultations based on scientific authentication and consideration of reality.
- C₃ - Employing Jurisprudential and Usul Sources (Traditional and Digital) and Scientific Databases in Research and Verification.
- C₄ - Applying jurisprudential knowledge to address contemporary issues in various fields (economic, medical, social, legal).

d. General Skills (Transferable):

- d₁ - Effective scientific communication in writing and presentation, and the preparation of research studies and reports in accordance with academic standards.
- d₂ - Working within research teams, and managing scientific projects efficiently and responsibly.
- d₃ - Utilization of modern technologies and digital platforms in research, teaching, and learning.
- d₄ - Commitment to the ethics of scientific research, values of integrity and honesty, and responsibility in issuing fatwas and jurisprudential work.



Program Learning Outcomes Matrix:

Master's Program Courses in Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Program Learning Outcomes															
	Knowledge and Understanding				Cognitive (Intellectual) Skills				Professional and Practical Skills				General Skills (Transferable)			
	a ₁	a ₂	a ₃	a ₄	b ₁	b ₂	b ₃	b ₄	C ₁	C ₂	C ₃	C ₄	d ₁	d ₂	d ₃	d ₄
Level 1	x	x														
Jurisprudence of Transactions	x	x	x		x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Jurisprudential Rules 1	x	x			x	x	x		x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Usul al-Fiqh 1	x	x				x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Family Jurisprudence				x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Level Two	x	x														
Jurisprudence of Criminal Law		x	x		x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Objectives of Islamic Law	x	x		x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Jurisprudential Rules 2	x	x			x	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Usul al-Fiqh 2		x				x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Contemporary Jurisprudential Issues			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Level Three																
The Fundamental Principles in the Differences Among Jurists	x	x			x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Usul al-Fiqh 3	x	x				x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x
The Classes of the Usuliyin	x	x		x		x	x		x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Comparative Jurisprudence	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Studies in the Sciences of the Sunnah			x				x	x	x		x		x	x	x	x
Level Four																
Principles of Jurisprudence 4	x	x				x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Jurisprudential Theories and Differences	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x

The Academic Thesis and Its Requirements :

First: Registration of the Thesis:

(1) Registration Conditions and Requirements:

The student is permitted to apply for registration of the thesis topic in the relevant department after fulfilling the following conditions:

- Fulfillment of the admission requirements for the postgraduate program.
- Successful completion of at least 50% of the academic courses.
- Achieving a cumulative GPA of no less than 70% in the academic courses.
- Submission of a comprehensive research proposal including: the thesis title, its significance, objectives, methodology, and previous studies.
- Approval of the Scientific Department Council, and endorsement of the subject by the competent authorities in accordance with the governing regulations.

(2) Registration Procedures:

- The student submits the thesis registration application to the academic department, accompanied by the research proposal.
- The proposal is presented to the relevant Scientific Committee for review and evaluation.
- After the topic is approved, the thesis is officially registered and ratified by the College Council and the relevant authorities.

Second: Academic Supervision:

(1) Regulations for Selecting the Academic Supervisor:

- The supervisor is selected from among the faculty members specialized in the field of the thesis.
- It is preferable that the supervisor holds the rank of Professor or Associate Professor; however, the assistance of an Assistant Professor is permissible in accordance with the approved regulations.
- It is permissible to appoint one or more co-supervisors when necessary, especially in interdisciplinary topics or specialized fields.

(2) Responsibilities of the Academic Supervisor:

- Providing academic guidance to the student in selecting and formulating the research topic.
- Monitoring the student's progress in the stages of thesis preparation on a regular basis.
- Reviewing academic chapters and providing necessary comments and corrections.
- Ensuring the student's adherence to the methodology and ethics of scientific research.
- Submitting periodic reports on the student's progress level to the relevant department.
- Recommendation for the thesis to be eligible for defense after fulfilling its academic requirements.

(3) Supervision and Follow-up Mechanisms:

- Conduct regular periodic meetings between the supervisor and the student to monitor the progress of the research.



- Submitting periodic reports on work progress in accordance with the approved templates.
- Continuous evaluation of the student's research performance, with addressing areas of deficiency.
- Adherence to the specified time frame for completing the thesis in accordance with the governing regulations.

Third: Discussion of the Thesis:

(1) Formation of the Discussion Committee:

Based on the Graduate Studies Regulations, the thesis defense committee shall be formed by a decision of the Graduate Studies Dean's Council, upon the recommendation of the relevant Department and Faculty Councils.

(2) Executive Rules for the Formation of the Committee:

- The supervisor's report is presented to the relevant departmental council as a preliminary step for approving the thesis's eligibility for discussion and proposing the formation of the examination and evaluation committee.
- The Department Council is responsible for nominating the members of the discussion committee, and it may propose a reserve member if necessary.
- The academic supervisor may propose a member of the discussion committee, provided that this is subject to the approval of the Department and Faculty Councils.
- In the event that the Graduate Studies Deanship Council deems it necessary to amend the proposed committee composition, coordination shall be made with the relevant faculty to approve the amendment.

(3) Thesis Submission Procedures and Evaluation:

- Copies of the thesis shall be sent to the members of the discussion committee through an official letter from the head of the relevant department, within a period not exceeding one week from the date the department is notified of the committee's approval.
- Each member of the discussion committee is obligated to submit a detailed scientific report on the thesis in accordance with the approved template.
- The maximum duration for thesis examination shall not exceed:
 - Two months for master's theses.
 - Three months for doctoral dissertations.
- This shall be effective from the date of receipt of the copy.
- In the event that a committee member delays submitting their report within the specified period, the Department Council – after being notified – may propose an alternative member to complete the evaluation procedures.

(4) Requirements for Progression to the Defense:

- Successful fulfillment of all academic program requirements.
- Obtaining the scientific supervisor's approval on the thesis's eligibility for discussion.
- Approval of the Department and Faculty Council for the validity of the thesis.
- Submission of the required copies of the thesis in accordance with the approved regulations.

(5) Procedures for the Defense and Approval of the Thesis

- The discussion session shall be held in the presence of the discussion committee and the supervisor (or their representative when necessary).
- The student presents a summary of their thesis, including the objectives, methodology, and results.
- The committee members provide their academic feedback, which is then discussed with the student in a scholarly manner.
- At the conclusion of the discussion, the committee issues its decision by selecting one of the following options:
 - A. The degree without modifications.
 - B. The license with specific amendments applied.
 - C. Postponement of the discussion to address substantial comments.
 - D. Failure to pass.

(6) Criteria for Evaluating the Scientific Thesis:

The discussion committee relies on a set of criteria to evaluate the thesis, the most prominent of which are:

- The originality, novelty, and contribution of the subject to the specialization.
- Scientific methodological soundness and accuracy of documentation.
- Scientific analysis, critique, and the ability to deduce.
- Organization of the thesis and its scientific sequence.
- Language Accuracy and Scientific Style.
- The extent to which the research objectives and the achieved scientific contribution have been fulfilled.

Organizational Note

All procedures for the discussion of scientific theses are subject to the approved regulations and executive rules at Imam Bukhary University.



Academic Rank	General Major	Specialization	Academic Position	Special Requirements and Skills	Required Number		
					Male	Female	Total
Professor	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Head of Department / Professor of Graduate Studies	General supervision of the postgraduate programs in the department, teaching advanced methodological courses (Fiqh, Usul al-Fiqh, Jurisprudential Rules, and Maqasid al-Shariah), supervising doctoral and master's theses, chairing examination committees, and directing the department's research trajectory.	1	0	1
Associate Professor	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Deputy Head of Department / Professor of Graduate Studies	Academic coordination of postgraduate programs, teaching courses (Fiqh and Usul, and Jurisprudential Theories), supervising master's and doctoral theses, and participating in examination committees and scientific seminars.	1	0	1
Professor / Associate Professor	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	General Jurisprudence	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses (Jurisprudence of Worship, Financial Transactions, Family Jurisprudence, and Criminal Jurisprudence), supervising academic theses that address the derivation of jurisprudential rulings.	1	1	2
Associate Professor / Assistant Professor	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Principles of Jurisprudence	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses (Usul al-Fiqh - evidences, indications, ijihad and taqlid - objectives of Sharia, and jurisprudential maxims), supervising master's theses, and training postgraduate students in skills of deduction and deriving branches from advanced principles.	2	1	3
Associate Professor / Assistant Professor	Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals	Comparative Jurisprudence and Contemporary Legal Issues	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses on Comparative Jurisprudence (studying contentious issues among the schools of thought, jurisprudence of contemporary urgent matters, and medical and economic issues), supervising academic theses concerned with the authentication of manuscript jurisprudential heritage, and training students in research methodologies for emerging issues.	1	1	2

Important Notes for Graduate Programs:

1. Teaching and Supervisory Load: The teaching load for postgraduate faculty members shall be reduced to enable them to dedicate themselves to supervising theses (Master's and Doctoral) and conducting scientific research, in accordance with the regulations of the Deanship of Graduate Studies.

2. Supervision Requirements: Supervisors of doctoral dissertations must hold the rank of «Professor» or «Associate Professor,» whereas «Assistant Professors» may supervise master's theses or participate in doctoral supervision under specific regulations.

3. Recruitment: The department focuses on attracting talents who have a substantial scientific output published in peer-reviewed scientific journals or accredited Arab journals, and who possess prior experience in supervision and examination.

Learning Resources for the Master's Program in Fiqh and Its Principles

To achieve the utmost educational and research benefits for the students of the Master's program in Fiqh and its Principles, the program at Imam Bukhary University relies on an integrated and diverse system of learning resources. These resources aim to equip students with solid jurisprudential and usul knowledge, and to develop skills in research, analysis, and ijihad concerning new issues, recent developments, and contemporary matters. These resources are distributed as follows:

1. Printed Books and References:

Available Books in the Central Library of the University: It includes a wide collection of the principal books of Islamic jurisprudence from various schools of thought, books on the principles of jurisprudence, jurisprudential rules, and the objectives of Shariah, in addition to modern references and specialized studies on contemporary jurisprudential issues.

Specialized Libraries: Utilizing faculty members' libraries and public libraries specialized in the sciences of jurisprudence, fundamentals, and Islamic studies.

2. Electronic Resources and Databases:

Electronic resources available in the databases of the digital library at Imam Bukhary University: These provide access to thousands of books and peer-reviewed scientific journals in the fields of Fiqh and its fundamentals, through the university's subscriptions to specialized scientific databases.

Peer-Reviewed Scientific Journals: Reviewing the latest research and studies in the sciences of Fiqh and Usul, through specialized jurisprudential and usul journals as well as academic databases.

3. Interactive and Educational Resources:

- **Notes and Visual Presentations:** Any notes or visual presentations (PowerPoint Presentations) uploaded by faculty members on the electronic learning system of Imam Bukhary University, which include lecture summaries, mind maps, interactive questions, and enrichment materials.

- **Recorded Lectures:** Visual recordings of academic lectures that enable students to review issues of jurisprudence, study the fundamentals, and understand the objectives of Sharia.

- **Discussion Forums:** Interactive platforms for discussing jurisprudential issues, analyzing the



reasons for differences and methods of preference, and exchanging scholarly opinions under specialized academic supervision.

4. Specialized Websites:

- **Reliable Academic Websites:** Websites of major legitimate scientific institutions, reputable fatwa centers, and jurisprudential councils that provide fatwas, research, and specialized articles in jurisprudence and its fundamentals.
- **Personal websites of scholars and researchers:** Utilizing the scientific content provided by prominent scholars and specialized researchers in Fiqh and its principles through their personal websites or their trusted educational channels.
- **Academic Research Gateways:** For accessing theses and peer-reviewed research in the field of Fiqh and its principles.

5. Internally Produced Educational Materials:

- **Authored and Translated Textbooks:** Books and publications produced by the faculty members of the department, whether original authorship or translations of important references, which reflect the academic and research expertise of the department and directly meet the scientific needs of the students.
- **Applied Studies and Exercises:** Educational materials specifically designed to train students in applying jurisprudential and fundamental principles to real-life issues and contemporary cases.

This integrated system of learning resources contributes to establishing a solid scientific foundation for students of Fiqh and its Principles, enabling them to acquire skills in examining evidence, critical analysis, scientific evaluation, discussion, and weighing arguments. This preparation qualifies them to engage with legislative sources in study, research, and teaching with competence and proficiency.

Admission and Student Support

The Master's Program in Fiqh and its Fundamentals at the Deanship of Graduate Studies places great emphasis on ensuring the recruitment of the best student talents and providing a supportive academic environment that enables them to achieve research and scientific excellence. This is accomplished through clear admission criteria and comprehensive support programs that meet the qualitative needs of graduate students.

1. Program Admission Requirements:

Applicants to the Master's program in Fiqh and its Principles must meet the general admission requirements for postgraduate studies at Imam Bukhary University, in addition to the following specific conditions:

- **Academic Qualification:** Must hold a Bachelor's degree in Jurisprudence and its Principles, or Sharia and Islamic Studies (General Major), or an equivalent qualification from a recognized university.
- **Cumulative GPA:** The cumulative GPA at the undergraduate level shall not be less than
- A minimum grade of «Good» or its equivalent is required; however, if the grade is «Acceptable,» admission may be considered under exceptional conditions determined by the Deanship of Graduate Studies.
- **Academic Recommendations:** Submission of two academic recommendations is required, especially if the applicant's undergraduate GPA is «Acceptable.» It is preferable that these recommendations be from professors who have previously taught the student during their undergraduate studies, if possible.
- **Admission Tests:** Passing the written and oral admission examination conducted by the department, which aims to assess specialized knowledge in the sciences of Fiqh and Usul, the ability for scientific research, and language skills (Arabic and English).
- **Curriculum Vitae:** Submission of a detailed curriculum vitae outlining the student's academic and research experiences.
- **Personal Interview:** Passing the personal interview conducted by the department to assess the student's readiness for postgraduate studies and their passion for scientific research in Fiqh and Usul.
- **Personal Documents:** Provide two recent passport-sized photographs, and a copy of the birth certificate/passport/national identity card.
- **Written Commitment:** A written pledge to adhere to the standards, rules, and general values promoted by Imam Bukhary University both within and outside the university, particularly the ethics of scientific research.
- **Registration Fees:** Payment of the prescribed registration fees at Ecobank, and submission of the payment receipt to Imam Bukhary University for verification.

2. Orientation and Preparation Programs for New Students:

Comprehensive orientation and induction programs are provided for new master's students to ensure their seamless integration into the academic and research environment of the Deanship of Graduate Studies, including:

1. **Reception Ceremony:** Organizing a reception ceremony for new students at the beginning of each academic semester to welcome them and introduce them to Imam Bukhary University and the department.
2. **Introductory Workshops:** Organizing specialized workshops to familiarize students with the



regulations and systems of postgraduate studies, the study plans of the master's program, research methodologies, and the proper use of specialized sources and references in Fiqh and its principles.

3. Orientation Tours: Organizing orientation tours of the Central Library, the Digital Library, study halls, language laboratories (if available), and the e-learning system.

4. Student Handbook: Providing each student with a comprehensive guide covering academic and administrative activities, regulations, and policies.

3. Guidance Services (Academic, Research, Professional, Psychological, Social):

The program provides specialized advisory services for master's students, with a focus on advanced research and academic aspects.

1. Academic and Research Supervision: An academic supervisor shall be assigned to each master's student from the commencement of the program until graduation, to provide advice and guidance in course selection, determination of the thesis topic, research methodology, and the writing of the scientific thesis.

2. Office Hours: Allocating regular office hours for faculty members to provide consultation and assistance to students concerning their field of specialization, as well as personal and social aspects that may affect their academic progression.

3. Academic Advising Unit: The presence of an academic advising unit within the college and department that guides students and provides...

4. Satisfaction Surveys: Distribution and dissemination of periodic questionnaires to measure students' satisfaction with academic and research advising services, and utilizing the results to develop continuous improvement plans.

5. Career Planning: Providing advice and guidance to students regarding the career opportunities available for holders of a Master's degree in Fiqh and its Fundamentals, and how to prepare for the academic and research job market.

4. Special Support:

The program is committed to providing special support for students with diverse needs to ensure equal opportunities and achieve excellence.

1. Supporting Students Facing Research and Academic Difficulties:

- Identifying students who are struggling in their research or academic path through supervisors' reports and course results.
- Identifying the causes of difficulties (such as challenges in research methodology, scientific writing, or time management) through individual meetings with supervisors and mentors.
- Providing individual or group support programs, such as intensive workshops in scientific research

methodology, academic writing, or time management skills.

- Guiding students to participate in specialized training courses to achieve the required levels and skills, such as advanced e-learning courses.

2. Support for Gifted and Outstanding Students:

- Identifying outstanding and gifted students in the field of Fiqh and its principles, and encouraging them to participate in scientific conferences and seminars.
- Providing them with advanced research opportunities and linking them to the research projects of the faculty members.
- Honoring them and commending their scientific and research achievements.
- Providing them with opportunities for leadership and pioneering roles in the scientific and cultural activities of the department and Imam Bukhary University.

3. Support for Persons with Disabilities:

- Providing dedicated and appropriate facilities for students with physical disabilities, such as designated parking spaces, equipped restrooms, and easily accessible pathways.
- Allocating appropriate spaces for them in lecture halls and libraries.
- Providing the necessary academic and technical support to ensure they receive a comprehensive educational and research experience.

Quality Assurance of the Master's Program in Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals

The Master's Program in Fiqh and its Fundamentals is committed to applying the highest standards of academic and administrative quality to ensure the excellence of its educational and research outcomes at the postgraduate level. This is achieved through an integrated quality assurance system encompassing all aspects of the program, aiming at the continuous improvement of performance, meeting the accreditation requirements for master's programs, and fulfilling the mission and strategic objectives of Imam Bukhary University in serving the Prophetic Sunnah and its sciences.

1. Quality Assurance System in the Program:

The program adopts an internal quality assurance system that aligns with the national and international standards for higher education and postgraduate programs. This system includes clear mechanisms for quality planning, implementation, monitoring, evaluation, and continuous improvement, which are carried out through:

- **Defining Quality Standards:** Establishing clear standards for the quality of advanced teaching, research curricula, scientific research (particularly theses), academic supervision, student services



directed towards postgraduate students, and research facilities.

- **Periodic Review:** Conducting periodic reviews of all program components by specialized internal and external committees in the sciences of Fiqh and its principles, as well as postgraduate studies.
- **Feedback:** Collecting and analyzing feedback from master's students, supervising faculty members, alumni, external examination committees, and research entities, to be utilized in improvement and development processes.
- **Improvement Plans:** Developing detailed action plans to address identified weaknesses and enhance strengths through evaluation processes, with a focus on the development of research skills and supervision.

2. Quality Monitoring Procedures for Program Courses Taught by Other Academic Departments:

To ensure consistency and quality in the courses taught by other departments (such as Advanced Arabic for Research, Research Methodologies, or certain related Sharia courses), the following procedures are implemented in coordination with the heads of the respective departments:

- **Systematic Coordination:** Holding periodic meetings with department heads and relevant faculty members to review course descriptions, content, teaching methods, and assessment approaches directed at postgraduate students, to ensure their alignment with the objectives of the Master's program in Fiqh and its Fundamentals.
- **Report Exchange:** Exchange of academic performance reports for master's students in these courses, as well as course evaluation reports by students and faculty members.
- **Joint Review:** Conduct joint reviews of the achieved learning outcomes in these courses, and provide recommendations for their improvement when necessary, with a focus on supporting the research skills of master's students.

3. Procedures Followed to Ensure Equivalence Between the Program's Main Campus and Other Branches (If Any)

In the event that there are other branches of the program or parallel tracks (such as a track for male students and a track for female students within a single main campus), the department ensures equivalence in the quality of education and available resources. Since the current program focuses on a single main campus, this point does not directly apply to the existence of independent branches. However, equivalence between male and female students at the main campus is ensured through:

- **Curriculum Unification:** The application of the same study plans and educational curricula for all master's students.
- **Equal resources:** Providing the same educational materials, research facilities, and advisory services to all students without discrimination.

- **Evaluation Criteria:** Application of standardized and fair assessment criteria for all students, including the evaluation of academic theses.

4. Program Plan for Measuring Learning Outcomes at the Program Level

The program adopts an approved plan for measuring learning outcomes at the course level and subsequently at the overall program level. This plan aims to ensure that master's students acquire the advanced knowledge, skills, and competencies specified in the program objectives, particularly in the field of scientific research in Fiqh and its principles. Learning outcomes are measured through:

- **Diverse Assessment Tools:** Utilization of various assessment tools such as advanced tests, research projects, seminar presentations, evaluation of thesis proposals, assessment of final theses, and oral interviews.
- **Results Analysis:** The outcomes of learning measurement are analyzed periodically, and the reports are discussed in the Department of Fiqh and Usul Council and the Graduate Studies Deanery Council.
- **Improvement Decision-Making:** Based on the results of the analysis and discussions, necessary decisions are made to enhance the quality of courses, develop teaching and supervision methods, and optimally utilize the expertise of faculty members to strengthen research outcomes.

5. Program Quality Evaluation:

The quality of the Master's program in Fiqh and its Fundamentals is periodically and regularly evaluated to ensure continuous improvement, in accordance with the performance indicators outlined in the following table:

Performance Indicators for the Master's Program in Fiqh and Its Fundamentals

m	Code	Performance Indicator	Target Audience	Measurement Methods	Measurement Timing
1	KPI-01	Percentage of Achievement of the Program's Operational Plan Objectives	75%	Committee Reports	End of the Academic Year
2	KPI-02	Student Satisfaction with the Quality of Juris-prudence and Its Fundamentals Courses	85%	Questionnaires	End of the semester
3	KPI-03	Student Satisfaction with the Competence of Faculty Members in the Major	85%	Questionnaires	End of the semester
4	KPI-04	Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs) Achievement Rate	75%	Measurement Reports	End of the semester



5	KPI-05	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) Achievement Rate	80%	Course Reports	End of the semester
6	KPI-06	Graduation Rate in the Program	60%	Academic Records	End of the Academic Year
7	KPI-07	Graduate Student Retention Rate	90%	Statistics	End of the semester
8	KPI-08	Pass Rate in Jurisprudence and Its Fundamentals Courses	85%	Academic Records	End of the semester
9	KPI-09	Graduate Employment Rate in Their Field of Specialization	40%	Graduate Surveys	Six months after graduation
10	KPI-10	Graduate Enrollment Rate in Postgraduate Studies ((Doctorate	%20	Graduate Surveys	Six months after graduation
11	KPI-11	Graduate Satisfaction with the Program	80%	Questionnaires	Annually
12	KPI-12	The number of scientific research publications annually in the field of Fiqh .and its principles	≥ 3 Research Papers	Quality Reports	Annually
13	KPI-13	Average Scientific Production of Faculty Members in the Specialization	≥ 1 Re-search/ Member	Research Reports	Annually
14	KPI-14	The percentage of utilization of jurisprudential and usul databases and digital technologies in research	70%	Course Reports	End of Semester
15	KPI-15	Number of Approved Theses in the Specialization	≥ 5 annually	Postgraduate Records	Annually
16	KPI-16	Number of participations in scientific conferences on Jurisprudence and Usul (Islamic Legal Theory)	≥ 2 annually	Department Reports	Annually
17	KPI-17	Student Satisfaction Rate with Academic Supervision of Theses	85%	Questionnaires	Annually

18	KPI-18	Number of Workshops and Courses in Jurisprudential and Usul Research Skills	annually 3 ≤	Training Reports	Annually
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Program Accreditation:

Accreditation Body	Department Council
Session Number	
Session Date	



جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY

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